



Addressing the Linux Talent Shortfall

Over the last few years, Linux has proved its worth in every vertical imaginable. Yet, corporate India is caught in a bind with Linux-conversant talent being virtually unavailable. Shenoy Systems has stepped in to speed up the process of getting talent industry-ready, especially in the embedded systems arena.

Linux is being hailed as the long-awaited magical wand for corporates looking at lowering the cost of building products. But the magicians seem missing, with not many developers skilled to employ Linux in building devices. Naveen Shenoy, MD and founder of Shenoy Systems, hopes his training solutions on Linux and embedded systems can fill the gap between corporates' demand for Linux expertise and the talent pool available, making the Linux magic happen!

First dip: embedded system solution provider

However, finding that perfect training spell wasn't instantaneous for Shenoy Systems. It involved a year-long journey, from an embedded system service provider to training solution provider, with one common thread—addressing the immediate need of the embedded industry. Recollecting the initial plunge, Shenoy says: "When I was to start Shenoy Systems, I was looking at addressing an immediate need of the embedded devices sector. With 11 years of experience in embedded systems, I felt there was a demand for an exclusive embedded system service provider, as companies that offered embedded services made the service team work on a project-to-project basis. Such a team lacked in-

depth knowledge on embedded systems."

This resulted in the birth of Shenoy Systems as an affordable and high-quality embedded systems service provider in October 2007, which offered end-to-end solutions for real-time systems (RTOS), design and development of firmware hardware abstraction layers and device drivers. The earliest clientele for their consultation/services around embedded systems included L&T, Tata Elxsi, Aspect Technologies and D-Link.

However, the initial journey wasn't free of obstacles. The company faced funding problems and hitches in the timely delivery of solutions. "Timely delivery of solutions was a problem mainly because Shenoy Systems was a one-man army then. I found it difficult to find appropriate talent to support my endeavours," says Shenoy, who has technical experience with Wind River, TATA Elxsi, and Park Controls.

Training solutions: The plunge again

But the obstacles turned to be a blessing in disguise. The difficulty faced by Shenoy to find well-equipped talent made him realise the need for training solutions in the embedded systems industry, especially with the rise of embedded Linux. This realisation led to the germination of the idea of providing Linux-based training